

merchant may even ask you for an ID or a PIN. Some credit card companies have software to estimate the probability of fraud. If an unusually large transaction is made, the issuer may even call you to verify.

Often people forget to collect their copy of the credit card receipt after eating at restaurants or elsewhere when they pay by credit card. These receipts have your credit card number and your signature for anyone to see and use. With only this information, someone can make purchases online or by phone. You won't notice it until you get your monthly statement, which is why you should carefully study your statements. Make sure the website is trustworthy and secure when shopping online. Some hackers may get a hold of your credit card number by employing phishing techniques.

Sometimes a tiny padlock icon appears on the left screen corner of the address bar on your browser which provides a higher level of security for data transmission. If you click on it, it will also tell you the encryption software it uses.

A more serious concern is the use of your personal information with the help of stolen or fake documents to open accounts (or even worse, using your existing account) to take a loan in your name. These unscrupulous people can collect your personal details from your mailbox or trash can (remember to shred all sensitive documents). Think of all the important details printed on those receipts, pay stubs and other documents. You won't know a thing until the credit card people track you down and tail you until you clear all your dues. Then for months and months you'll be fighting to get your credit restored and your name cleared.

With rising cases of credit card fraud, many financial institutions have stepped in with software solutions to monitor your credit and guard your identity. ID theft insurance can be taken to recover lost wages and restore your credit. But before you spend a fortune on these services, apply the no-cost, common sense measures to avert such a crime.

11. Salami slicing attack

A "salami slicing attack" or "salami fraud" is a technique by which cyber-criminals steal money or resources a bit at a time so that there's no noticeable difference in overall size. The perpetrator gets away with these little pieces from a large number of resources and thus accumulates a considerable amount over a period of time. The essence of this method is the failure to detect the misappropriation.

The most classic approach is "collect-the-roundoff" technique. Most calculations are carried out in a particular currency are rounded off *up* to